

REPORT ON SIGNIFICANT ACHIEVEMENTS AT INSTITUTIONS/ORGANIZATIONS WHERE I HAVE WORKED

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My professional career of more than three decades has been devoted to the development, promotion and sustainable management of Nepal's tourism sector. I have worked with the Government of Nepal, Nepal Tourism Board, National Planning Commission, Lumbini Development Trust, local governments, international development agencies, private tourism organizations and academic institutions. My major achievements have been in **tourism policy formulation, strategic planning, institutional coordination, destination development, tourism product innovation, sustainable tourism, market development, heritage conservation and human-resource development.**

1. Contribution to National Tourism Policy and Strategic Planning

One of my most significant achievements has been my contribution to national tourism policy and long-term planning. As a **Tourism Task Force Member and Tourism Specialist at the National Planning Commission**, I contributed to preparation of the **Ninth Five-Year Plan (1997–2002) for the tourism sector**, including analysis of tourism's economic contribution, market trends, forecasts, policy issues and a 20-year perspective for tourism development.

As **Deputy Team Leader and Tourism Planner**, I contributed to preparation of the **Ecotourism in Nepal–Future Direction, Nepal Tourism Development Master Plan 2008**, with specific responsibility for tourism product development, marketing and promotion, Tourism Satellite Account orientation and tourism forecasting.

As **Senior Advisor to Nepal Tourism Board, Coordinator of Nepal Tourism Year 2011 and Technical Advisor to the Ministry of Tourism**, I contributed to national tourism capacity-building programmes and the formulation of **Tourism Policy 2065 and Tourism Vision 2020 for Sustainable Tourism Development.**

2. Innovation in Tourism Development

Throughout my career, I have introduced and promoted innovative approaches to tourism development. These include **ecotourism, community-based tourism, rural tourism, destination diversification, homestay management, heritage walks, integrated destination management and tourism information systems.**

As Team Leader/Ecotourism Specialist, I prepared ecotourism plans for destinations including Gorkha, Western Terai, Taplejung, Dolpa, Tansen and Lumbini, integrating conservation, local economic benefits, infrastructure, marketing and visitor management.

An early innovative initiative was my work with the **Department of Tourism on establishing a Tourism Internet Highway System**, demonstrating my early recognition of information technology as an important instrument for tourism development and promotion.

I also contributed to the development of a **community-based village resort model for Bhadravas and Lamatar**, linking tourism development with local employment and community participation.

3. Sustainable and Community-Oriented Tourism

Sustainable tourism has remained a central principle of my professional work. As National Consultant and Tourism Research Specialist for **UNDP/UN-WTO's Tourism for Sustainable Development in Nepal**, I contributed to formulation of a comprehensive sustainable tourism master plan integrating long-term strategy with short-term action programmes.

I subsequently contributed to conservation and ecotourism planning for **the community forests in Bardia, Chitwan, Bagmara, Chitrasen, Shivapuri, Shey-Phoksundo, Rara, Western Terai**, seeking to link conservation with local economic benefits.

4. Heritage Conservation and Tourism Product Development

I have also contributed to transforming Nepal's cultural heritage into tourism products while supporting conservation.

As **Culture and Heritage Tourism Specialist**, I worked on conservation and tourism planning for **Hanuman Dhoka Durbar Square** and Kathmandu Metropolitan City. I also contributed to implementation of **Heritage Walks in Kathmandu City Core**, designed to strengthen conservation awareness, encourage private-sector participation, extend tourist stays and generate local socio-economic benefits.

As Coordinator of the **Bhadrakali Conservation Programme**, I coordinated government, heritage and local stakeholders to integrate conservation with tourism promotion.

5. Institutional and Programme Leadership

As **Member-Secretary of the Steering Committee and Executive Director of Lumbini Development Trust**, I was directly involved in planning and execution of the **Second World Buddhist Summit 2004** at Lumbini. My responsibilities included programme planning, financial administration, stakeholder coordination, monitoring and evaluation.

I also served on the **Board of Kathmandu Upatyaka Khanepani Limited**, contributing to policy formulation, monitoring and evaluation and institutional performance improvement.

These assignments strengthened my ability to lead complex programmes involving government agencies, private organizations, international partners and local stakeholders.

6. Tourism Market Research, Standards and Quality Improvement

As **Team Leader for the National Tourism Demand Survey among Trekking Agencies**, I conducted research on tourism products, market segments, visitor motivations, trekking routes, services, facilities, market structures and opportunities for new products and community participation.

As **Tourism Standard Development Specialist under the ADB-supported Tourism Sector Development Project**, I contributed to development of tourism industry standards, classification systems, monitoring and evaluation mechanisms, codes of ethics and conduct, institutional responsibilities and human-resource development recommendations.

7. Recent Strategic Contributions

My recent assignments demonstrate the continuing application of these achievements. As Tourism Specialist for **Bagmati Province**, I prepared the **15-year Tourism Development Strategy**, providing a roadmap for infrastructure, human resources, marketing, regulation and sustainable and inclusive tourism development.

I also led the **Feasibility Study of the Integrated Tourism Development Programme in Bhaktapur Provincial Assembly Constituency No. 1**, identifying tourism potential, a flagship destination and an integrated framework for sustainable destination management and economic contribution.

My principal achievement has been the continuous conversion of tourism knowledge into **policies, strategies, plans, institutions, products and practical development interventions**. My professional record demonstrates leadership across national policy, institutional management, private-sector tourism, destination development, sustainable tourism, heritage conservation, market research and innovation.

I have consistently worked toward a tourism model that is **market-oriented, sustainable, decentralized, community-inclusive, knowledge-based and economically productive**. My experience therefore provides a strong foundation for contributing to the transformation of the Nepal Tourism Board into a more **strategic, performance-oriented, market-intelligent, digitally enabled and globally competitive national tourism organization**.

Dr. Gyanendra Ratna Tuladhar